

Diesel to keep rising as crude holds in \$90-\$110 band

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【メール原文】

Crude prices will remain in the \$90-\$110 band, though products will face greater pressure. The US continues to move oil through the Strait of Hormuz, |||||

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Despite US success in moving oil through the Strait of Hormuz, crude prices will remain elevated, and product prices will continue to climb.

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Refinery outages and shipping disruptions caused by the Middle East and Russia-Ukraine conflicts will remain key sources of pressure, especially as Russian diesel exports collapse.

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Saudi Arabia will shift its crude exports to the Persian Gulf, taking advantage of the US escort system as the East-West pipeline slowly comes back online.

Crude prices will remain in the \$90-\$110 band, though products will face greater pressure. The US continues to move oil through the Strait of Hormuz, though constant Iranian attacks make the undertaking hazardous and expensive. While crude prices have settled somewhat, with the Brent front month trading around \$100 per barrel, refined products (particularly middle distillates such as diesel) remain under intense pressure owing to reduced global refining capacity. Frequent attacks in the Persian Gulf, Red Sea, and Black Sea have caused shipping rates to soar (see: Middle East's deepening crisis will keep crude prices above \$100 , 14 September 2026).

While there may be some halfhearted moves this week to de-escalate the US-Iran confrontation as world leaders meet for the UN General Assembly in New York City, without a substantive shift in either the US or Iranian position, a deal remains unlikely (see: High prices likely throughout 2026 as US-Iran standoff endures , 18 September 2026).

Red Sea and Black Sea disruptions are contributing to the tight global diesel market. Ongoing Ukrainian attacks on Russian energy infrastructure have further reduced Russian exports of both crude and refined products. Russian exports of diesel and gasoil have plunged from 800,000 bpd to less than 200,000 bpd over the last twelve months, as Moscow reserves domestic supplies for internal consumption. The shutdown of the Saudi East-West pipeline means fewer cargoes are flowing from the Red Sea: Saudi Aramco canceled orders to European customers for both September and October.

The tightest markets are in the North Atlantic. The physical prices for some Norwegian crudes are above \$130 per barrel, putting them at a premium of more than \$15 over Brent. While Norwegian crudes

often trade higher than Brent, the large premium indicates a tight Northwest European market. At the region's most important oil trading hub of Amsterdam-Rotterdam-Antwerp, fuel stocks remain near multi-year lows despite a recent uptick in inventories following the end of the high-demand summer holiday season in late August.

A US restriction on diesel exports would add even more pressure to non-US prices. While the US government has not announced plans to restrict diesel exports to rein in skyrocketing prices, the issue has received greater attention (see: Refined product export restrictions likely if prices remain elevated , 16 September 2026) . Global exports of diesel and gasoil have dropped sharply in the last year owing to the conflicts in the Middle East and Russia-Ukraine; a US restriction would further tighten supplies, contributing to high prices, particularly in South America and Europe.

Saudi exports will shift to the Persian Gulf. Following the successful attack on the East-West pipeline, Saudi Arabia has ceased exporting oil out of the Red Sea terminal at Yanbu. Saudi exports are now flowing through the Persian Gulf, contributing to the volume of crude moving through the US-sponsored escort system, while also exposing Saudi tankers to Iranian attack.

While the East-West pipeline is likely to restart operations soon, repairs may take several weeks before capacity returns to its previous level of 4 million-5 million bpd.

Gregory Brew

Senior Analyst, Iran & Energy

+1 646 259 3207

brew@eurasiagroup.net

Henning Gloystein

Managing Director, Energy & Resources

+44 (0)73 898 444 98

gloystein@eurasiagroup.net

EG Energy, Climate & Resources

ecr@eurasiagroup.net

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